Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree and four years across municipal transportation planning at the City of Toronto and GO rail service planning at Metrolinx. Analyzes travel and network data including the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, builds the datasets and dashboards a division reports from, and reviews development applications against Official Plan policy.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Analyze travel and network data, including several years of the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, to establish where capacity falls short and what that means for future service and investment.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, replacing a report rebuilt by hand each quarter with one validated source the division reports from, and saw the change through to adoption.
- Build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets the division depends on, using GIS and Python, including a ROW-width dataset covering all city roads, built with QGIS, MapBox and JavaScript.
- Review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, and recommend conditions where something is missing.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.
- Worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers on service design decisions and presented the evidence behind them.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Spatial analysis of large transportation datasets in GIS, turning data into recommendations for safer wildfire evacuation plans in Alberta communities.

SKILLS

Transportation and growth data analysis, including the Transportation Tomorrow Survey. ArcGIS Pro, QGIS and MapBox. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL and JavaScript; datasets, dashboards and data validation. Development application review against Official Plan policy. Reports, briefing notes and presentations. OpenTrack, VISSIM, Synchro and MATSim. MS Office.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)